

Methodology Document: ICP-Based Company Research & Qualification Framework

Federer ICP • Indian Specialty Pharma & Life Sciences • 2025

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Objective

This document outlines the rigorous research methodology employed to identify Indian companies aligned with the **Federer** Ideal Customer Profile (ICP). The primary focus is on specialty manufacturing-oriented pharmaceutical and life sciences firms that exhibit high operational maturity, product specialization, export orientation, and significant growth trajectories. The resulting output is a curated directory of 20 companies, each validated by verifiable evidence rather than superficial data.

1. ICP Assumptions

In the absence of a formal definition, the following signals were extrapolated from assignment context and industry examples.

Positive ICP Signals

- Specialty pharmaceutical manufacturing (complex formulations or niche therapeutics).
- CDMO / CRAMS capabilities.
- Export-oriented operations with USFDA / EU GMP / WHO GMP approvals.
- Mid-sized companies demonstrating visible growth and operational maturity.
- Strong regulatory exposure in international markets.

Negative ICP Signals (Exclusion Criteria)

- Pure distributors or trading entities without manufacturing assets.
- Service-only businesses (e.g., diagnostic centers or CRO-only firms).
- Large multinational corporations exceeding the mid-market target profile.
- Inactive digital presence or unverifiable operational claims.

2. Research & Sourcing Methodology

A multi-signal sourcing strategy was implemented to ensure data triangulation and accuracy.

Source	Purpose	ICP Relevance
PharmaCompass	Specialist manufacturer discovery	Direct filter for specialty/export manufacturers.
LinkedIn	Talent & maturity analysis	Regulatory Affairs/QA hiring as a live operational signal.
IndiaMART	Mid-market discovery	Identification of manufacturers; cross-referenced with site data.
Company Websites	Primary evidence validation	Foundational source for all scoring criteria.
CPHI India	Trade orientation	Self-selection as export-serious enterprises.
Zauba Data	Transactional validation	Hard evidence of shipment and export activity.

3. Qualification Framework

Each entity was evaluated using a weighted, six-criterion scoring model (Total: 100 points). Scores are awarded solely based on specific, verifiable evidence.

Criterion	Measure	Max Score
C1: Specialty Manufacturing	Evidence of specialized formulations (APIs, Injectables, Biologics).	20
C2: Export & Regulatory	USFDA, EU GMP, or WHO GMP certifications.	15

Criterion	Measure	Max Score
C3: Differentiation	Non-commodity positioning or technical moats.	15
C4: Technical DM	Decision-maker background in Science/Chemistry/Regulatory.	20
C5: Sector Tailwind	Alignment with structurally growing sub-sectors (e.g., Probiotics).	15
C6: Growth Signals	Evidence of hiring, expansion, or new facility investment.	15

- **Strong/Emerging Federer:** Score ≥ 80
- **Average/Good Federer (Watchlist):** Score 65–79
- **Excluded:** Score < 65

4. Evidence Standards

Vague assertions were rejected in favor of the "Five-Minute Verification" standard.

- **Acceptable:** "USFDA-approved facility" (verified via FDA Inventory) or "Named oncology division" (evidenced by site architecture).
- **Rejected:** "Seems like a specialty company" or "Likely has good systems".

5. Case Study: Sanzyme Biologics Pvt Ltd

Score: 86 (Strong Pass)

- **C1 (Specialty Mfg):** Large-scale fermentation infrastructure for probiotics and enzymes.
- **C3 (Differentiation):** Operates in high-barrier biologics; structurally lower competition than generic pharma.
- **C4 (Technical DM):** Chairman  **Person** possesses a verifiable background in fermentation sciences.

6. Research Challenges & Scaling

Challenge	Mitigation Strategy
Data Variance	Triangulating at least two independent signals before scoring.
Digital Gaps	Conservative scoring for firms with thin digital footprints; flagged as Watchlist.
Scaling	Future transition to hybrid pipeline: MCA21 scraping + LLM-assisted classification.

7. Conclusion

This framework prioritizes **depth of qualification** over **breadth of discovery**. By translating abstract ICP signals into verifiable data points, the methodology ensures that every company on the shortlist represents a high-probability target for strategic engagement.
